# LAND & LEDGERS

## HISTORICAL TIMELINE, EVENTS AND ECONOMIC REGIMES

### RESEARCH REFERENCE — FIRST EDITION (STEP 08)

**Date:** 8 October 2026 | **Period:** 1870–1905 | **Authority:** Reference and authoring evidence only; Canon XXXI governs mechanics.

This catalog is deliberately a **dated, cited research record**, not a list of automatic economic modifiers. A nationwide crisis may create financial/counterparty strain while a rural Dakota node without relevant lender connections sees a delayed or small effect. Conversely, an independently generated drought or lender failure is still allowed when named historical event injection is disabled.

## I. Four noninterchangeable classes of historical entry

1. **Authored historical event (`EVT`)** — A researched named crisis, outbreak, or incident that may inject scoped causal inputs only when enabled by the scenario Historical Events setting.
2. **Historical period or regime (`REG`)** — A longer state of institutions, outside trade networks or development conditions; effects still require real local exposure, information and counterparties.
3. **Legal or availability boundary (`LAW`/`CTX`)** — A fixed date when legal jurisdiction, organizational powers or channel availability changes; these are not discretionary crisis cards and are not disabled merely by toggling Historical Events OFF.
4. **Campaign baseline (`HIST`)** — World setup envelope and authoring priors; dated evidence should constrain generation but must not force historical outcomes when player/NPC action changes the conditions.

## II. Event-evaluation grammar

EventDefinition (stable ID) -> date window and applicable region -> research/evidence check -> scenario authored toggle if applicable -> affected authoritative inputs (weather/route, finance/lender, crop/animal, information, person/household, law) -> ordinary tasks, agreement performance, prices and choices -> player-facing evidence and forecast.

**Never inject:** arbitrary Revenue=-20%, Population+50, immediate livestock disappearance, a depot because the calendar reached 1886, automatic bankruptcy upon panic, or an invisible forced settlement script.

**Event record minimum fields:** ID; title; valid period and geographic scope; class/toggle eligibility; historical source and research grade; local exposure conditions; causal input authorities; known uncertainty; save version; applied-event identity; reversible or irreversible actions; narrative/reporting access; scenario-specific overrides.

## III. Verified and provisional catalog

| ID | Event / regime | Time | Classification | Research status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `HIST-1870-BASE` | Early 1870 frontier baseline | 1870-01-01 | Baseline / historical context | DESIGN BASELINE |
| `EVT-1872-EQUINE` | Great equine influenza epizootic | 1872 | Authored historical regional disease event | PROVISIONAL — RESEARCH GEOGRAPHY |
| `EVT-1873-PANIC` | Panic of 1873 and following contraction | 1873-09 | Authored historical financial regime | VERIFIED CORE, CALIBRATION OPEN |
| `EVT-1874-GRASSHOPPER` | Northern plains grasshopper outbreaks | 1874 | Authored environmental regime candidate | RESEARCH HOLD |
| `REG-1878-1880-GROWTH` | Dakota settlement and land-entry expansion | 1878 | Long regional historical regime / migration context | REGIONAL SYNTHESIS — NEED ROUTE DATA |
| `EVT-1884-PANIC` | Panic of 1884 | 1884-05 | Authored financial event | VERIFIED NATIONAL |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | candidate with limited spread | SCOPE; LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL |
| `EVT-1886-WINTER` | Severe northern plains winter of 1886–87 | 1886-11 | Authored regional environmental disaster | VERIFIED REGIONAL, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN |
| `EVT-1888-BLIZZARD` | Children's Blizzard, 12 January 1888 | 1888-01-12 | Authored dated weather/route disturbance | VERIFIED DATE AND SOME REGIONAL EFFECTS |
| `LAW-1889-STATE` | Dakota statehood / jurisdiction transition | 1889-11-02 | Historical legal boundary | VERIFIED HISTORICAL DATE |
| `EVT-1890-PANIC` | Financial strain and Panic of 1890 | 1890 | Authored national financial event candidate | VERIFIED EVENT, LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL |
| `EVT-1893-PANIC` | Panic of 1893 and depression | 1893 | Authored financial regime | VERIFIED MACRO, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN |
| `CTX-1896-RFD` | Rural Free Delivery experimentation begins | 1896-10-01 | Technology/service availability chronology | VERIFIED ONSET |
| `LAW-1898-BANKRUPTCY` | Federal Bankruptcy Act of 1898 | 1898-07-01 | Historical federal legal boundary | VERIFIED LEGAL EVENT |
| `LAW-1902-RECLAMATION` | Reclamation Act of 1902 | 1902-06-17 | Historical federal institutional/legal boundary | VERIFIED ENACTMENT, PROJECT MAPPING OPEN |
| `CTX-1905-END` | Normal historical envelope ends | 1905-12-31 | Campaign authoring boundary | DESIGN BOUNDARY |

## IV. Individual historical research entries

### HIST-1870-BASE — Early 1870 frontier baseline

**Period:** 1870-01-01 to 1872-12-31. **Class:** Baseline / historical context. **Geography:** Dakota and nearby plains.

**Evidence:** Source synthesis; DESIGN BASELINE.

**Causal/world pathways:** Sparse local rail/telegraph support, established animal/river transport, rural social and commercial networks.

**Caution / eligibility:** Opening scenario may begin in spring 1870; do not turn off geography with event toggle.

**Sources:** Canon XXXI PDF pp.72–82 (preserved Canon XXV).

### EVT-1872-EQUINE — Great equine influenza epizootic

**Period:** 1872 to 1873. **Class:** Authored historical regional disease event. **Geography:** North America; per-district exposure must be sourced.

**Evidence:** Library of Congress archival; PROVISIONAL — RESEARCH GEOGRAPHY.

**Causal/world pathways:** Affected horse availability/condition -> wagon, stage, delivery, freight and ordinary travel capacity -> service delays and economic consequences.

**Caution / eligibility:** Do not assume every Dakota team infected simultaneously or apply universal revenue loss.

**Sources:** https://blogs.loc.gov/manuscripts/2026/05/when-the-horse-flu-came-for-alexander-graham-bells-boston/.

### EVT-1873-PANIC — Panic of 1873 and following contraction

**Period:** 1873-09 to 1879 (broad aftermath; exact use scoped). **Class:** Authored historical financial regime. **Geography:** United States; local lender exposure conditional.

**Evidence:** Federal Reserve / US Treasury; VERIFIED CORE, CALIBRATION OPEN.

**Causal/world pathways:** Rail bond markets and institutions -> financing availability, withdrawals, lender risk, project cancellations -> employment, migration and purchases.

**Caution / eligibility:** No direct price/profit percentage debuff; credit network and geography determine impact.

**Sources:** https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age ; https://home.treasury.gov/about/history/freedmans-bank-building/financial-panic-of-1873.

### EVT-1874-GRASSHOPPER — Northern plains grasshopper outbreaks

**Period:** 1874 to 1877. **Class:** Authored environmental regime candidate. **Geography:** Regional agriculture; site/year intensity to be established.

**Evidence:** Canon source only pending direct dated corroboration; RESEARCH HOLD.

**Causal/world pathways:** Actual crop loss and planting decisions -> household food and feed, credit, migration, merchant supply.

**Caution / eligibility:** Not eligible for exact dated scripted effects until Dakota evidence is verified.

**Sources:** Canon XXXI preserved historical regime material (pages 25–35); additional period records required.

### REG-1878-1880-GROWTH — Dakota settlement and land-entry expansion

**Period:** 1878 to 1887. **Class:** Long regional historical regime / migration context. **Geography:** Dakota Territory, corridors differ.

**Evidence:** Canon synthesis with chronology hold; REGIONAL SYNTHESIS — NEED ROUTE DATA.

**Causal/world pathways:** Awareness, claims, rail approaches, land sales/settlement contacts, credit -> actor decisions and construction.

**Caution / eligibility:** The historical label Great Dakota Boom must not force the same town growth in every seed.

**Sources:** Canon XXXI preserved XXV/XXIX.

### EVT-1884-PANIC — Panic of 1884

**Period:** 1884-05 to 1884. **Class:** Authored financial event candidate with limited spread. **Geography:** Predominantly New York financial firms.

**Evidence:** Federal Reserve History; VERIFIED NATIONAL SCOPE; LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL.

**Causal/world pathways:** Bank/funding relationship exposure -> reputation, correspondent terms and firm borrowing where actual connections exist.

**Caution / eligibility:** Do not treat as nationwide depression.

**Sources:** https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age.

### EVT-1886-WINTER — Severe northern plains winter of 1886–87

**Period:** 1886-11 to 1887-04. **Class:** Authored regional environmental disaster. **Geography:** Northern Plains cattle range; heterogeneous local severity.

**Evidence:** US National Park Service; VERIFIED REGIONAL, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN.

**Causal/world pathways:** Local snow/ice, forage scarcity, weakened livestock and limited water -> injury, starvation, losses, herd distress -> finance and market effects.

**Caution / eligibility:** Do not globally delete 80% of all Dakota cattle; losses varied widely by specific location and husbandry.

**Sources:** https://www.nps.gov/thro/learn/historyculture/theodore-roosevelt-the-rancher.htm ; https://www.nps.gov/grko/learn/historyculture/winter.htm.

### EVT-1888-BLIZZARD — Children's Blizzard, 12 January 1888

**Period:** 1888-01-12 to 1888-01. **Class:** Authored dated weather/route disturbance. **Geography:** Eastern Dakota and upper Midwest hardest; Black Hills different.

**Evidence:** US National Weather Service; VERIFIED DATE AND SOME REGIONAL EFFECTS.

**Causal/world pathways:** Extreme cold, winds and drift -> impassable routes, telegraph disruption, rail stoppage, exposed Persons/animals, delays.

**Caution / eligibility:** Do not assume uniform fatalities, snowfall or service failure at every node.

**Sources:** https://www.weather.gov/unr/1888-01-12.

### LAW-1889-STATE — Dakota statehood / jurisdiction transition

**Period:** 1889-11-02 to ongoing. **Class:** Historical legal boundary; NON-OPTIONAL except alternate history. **Geography:** North Dakota and South Dakota.

**Evidence:** US Senate state timeline; VERIFIED HISTORICAL DATE.

**Causal/world pathways:** Territorial to state legal-institution regime; existing contracts, institutions and geography require actual continuity rules.

**Caution / eligibility:** Must remain effective when Historical Events toggle is OFF.

**Sources:** https://www.senate.gov/states/SD/timeline.shtml ; https://www.senate.gov/states/ND/timeline.shtml.

### EVT-1890-PANIC — Financial strain and Panic of 1890

**Period:** 1890 to 1890. **Class:** Authored national financial event candidate. **Geography:** Money centers; regional links uncertain.

**Evidence:** Federal Reserve History; VERIFIED EVENT, LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL.

**Causal/world pathways:** Money-center liquidity/reputational strain may transmit along actual correspondent and credit ties.

**Caution / eligibility:** Not a universal Dakota banking shutdown.

**Sources:** https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age.

### EVT-1893-PANIC — Panic of 1893 and depression

**Period:** 1893 to 1897 (broad later recovery). **Class:** Authored financial regime. **Geography:** US-wide banking, rail and regional exposure varies.

**Evidence:** Federal Reserve History; FDIC history; VERIFIED MACRO, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN.

**Causal/world pathways:** Depositor withdrawal, gold/monetary strain, railroad failure, lender liquidity, contracting commerce and credit -> local propagation.

**Caution / eligibility:** Never directly reduce each firm revenue; impose/derive only causal changes.

**Sources:** https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age ; https://www.fdic.gov/history/1850-1899.

### CTX-1896-RFD — Rural Free Delivery experimentation begins

**Period:** 1896-10-01 to adoption varies by place. **Class:** Technology/service availability chronology; NON-OPTIONAL factual boundary. **Geography:** Initial experiment West Virginia; later routes elsewhere.

**Evidence:** US Postal Service; VERIFIED ONSET.

**Causal/world pathways:** Actual post-office/route roll-out changes mail travel, shopping information and market reach, not immediate universal rural delivery.

**Caution / eligibility:** Do not grant every Dakota household home delivery in 1896.

**Sources:** https://about.usps.com/who/profile/history/rural-free-delivery.htm.

### LAW-1898-BANKRUPTCY — Federal Bankruptcy Act of 1898

**Period:** 1898-07-01 to ongoing. **Class:** Historical federal legal boundary; NON-OPTIONAL except alternate history. **Geography:** United States with eligibility/court constraints.

**Evidence:** Federal Judicial Center / US Courts; VERIFIED LEGAL EVENT.

**Causal/world pathways:** Adds federal bankruptcy proceeding path separate from state law; no modern Chapter 7/11 mechanics.

**Caution / eligibility:** No automatic dissolution or universal personal bankruptcy reset.

**Sources:** https://www.rib.uscourts.gov/sites/default/files/FJC%20Bankruptcy%20Timeline.pdf ; https://www.mnb.uscourts.gov/history-us-bankruptcy-court-district-minnesota.

### LAW-1902-RECLAMATION — Reclamation Act of 1902

**Period:** 1902-06-17 to ongoing. **Class:** Historical federal institutional/legal boundary. **Geography:** Affected western projects; local site inclusion not guaranteed.

**Evidence:** US Bureau of Reclamation; VERIFIED ENACTMENT, PROJECT MAPPING OPEN.

**Causal/world pathways:** Federal planning/finance capacity for authorized irrigation work; individual projects need budgets, land, labor, water and construction.

**Caution / eligibility:** Act does not auto-build every western irrigation system.

**Sources:** https://www.usbr.gov/history/borhist.html ; https://www.usbr.gov/gp/about_us/aboutus_history.html.

### CTX-1905-END — Normal historical envelope ends

**Period:** 1905-12-31 to 1905-12-31. **Class:** Campaign authoring boundary. **Geography:** Default campaign.

**Evidence:** Canon XXXI; DESIGN BOUNDARY.

**Causal/world pathways:** End-of-envelope for period accuracy; scenario may end earlier or authored continuation separately.

**Caution / eligibility:** Avoid 1908 mail-order kit homes or post-1913 Federal Reserve systems in ordinary 1870-1905 scenarios.

**Sources:** Canon XXXI (current revision, p.1 and historical envelope appendix).

## V. Research holds and exclusions

- **Grasshopper and local crop crises:** An 1874–1877 episode is a promising historical regime candidate but requires direct Dakota time/place/source confirmation before implementing a fixed event ID with local crop multipliers.
- **Great Dakota Boom:** Treat settlement, railway approach, migration and land acquisition as processes through real agents; do not force every player settlement to grow on a historical aggregate boom schedule.
- **Railroad arrival:** Retain independent infrastructure and commercial service stages; Black Hills and Southeastern Dakota rail dates require corridor and corporate verification.
- **Indigenous treaty, reservation and land-law changes:** Land jurisdiction and rights require their own REF-02 legal-geography catalog; they are not generic optional 'disaster' toggles.
- **Conflicting mortality/loss percentages:** Ranch loss figures from different NPS cases apply to their described herds and ranges; never generalize a local 80% report to all ranches.
- **Post-horizon exclusions:** Postal Parcel Post (1913), the Federal Reserve System (1913) and Sears kit houses beginning in 1908 must not enter normal-period availability catalogs by mistake.

## VI. Acceptance fixtures

**PANIC-1873 OFF:** Authored national Panic inputs do not inject; an organic bank with real deposit-liquidity shortage can still fail.

**PANIC-1873 ON, isolated town:** Only connected lenders, railway finance and other real economic routes transmit relevant historical disturbance; unrelated local inventories are not automatically repriced.

**BLIZZARD-1888 geographic contrast:** Physical route and communication damage in a represented corridor may differ materially across Black Hills and eastern Dakota; do not stamp the same fatality, snow-depth or road-blocking profile everywhere.

**STATEHOOD-1889 event toggle OFF:** Dated state/legal geography remains in effect; existing debt/title/Persons persist without being rewritten.

**RFD-1896:** An isolated Dakota farm does not automatically receive a newly completed rural mail route simply because West Virginia began a federal experiment.

**RECLAMATION-1902:** Federal program exists, but unfinished local irrigation works do not produce water deliveries or create farm revenue until actual projects and water-service rights exist.

## VII. Evidence standard

Official government histories and period engineering records support specific factual dates or mechanisms. Geographic extrapolation is labeled. A reference date does not prove exact profitability, incidence, labor days or annual event magnitude in a procedurally generated town. Scenario-specific numeric calibration requires separate evidence.

**Next linked reference:** Historical Law, Land Rights and Institutions (REF-02), followed by economy and workforce calibration refreshes.